

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff and a bass line on a bass clef staff. The key signature has one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 12/8. The melody is characterized by a steady eighth-note pulse. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the first system; Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the second system; F, C, Dm, A, Dm, C, Dm, C, F in the third system; and Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the fourth system. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three lines of text. The first system of lyrics is: '1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide, 2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth; 3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;'. The second system is: 'in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side; they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth. though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.'. The third system is: 'Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust, Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be, Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side'. The fourth system is: 'ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just; nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key. till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.'.

Dm A B $\flat$ A Dm F C Dm A7 Dm

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

Dm A B $\flat$ A Dm F C Dm A7 Dm

in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

F C Dm A Dm C Dm C F

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

Dm A B $\flat$ A Dm F C Dm A7 Dm

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just;
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